Wallpaper Planner

User Manual

A browser-rendered productivity dashboard
displayed as your macOS desktop wallpaper

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1 Overview

The Wallpaper Planner turns your Mac desktop into a live productivity dashboard. Three panels are always visible behind your windows, giving you a persistent view of:

- **Today's tasks** — a checklist for the current daily sprint
- **1-Week Horizon** — a Gantt chart of everything due this week
- **2-Week Radar** — a wider Gantt chart covering the next two weeks

The dashboard is a local HTML file rendered by **Plash**, a free macOS utility that displays web pages as desktop wallpaper. All content is controlled by a single plain-text file (`tasks.js`) — no coding required to keep it up to date.

1.1 File Structure

```
planning-wallpaper/
├── tasks.js          ← edit this daily
├── wallpaper.html    ← dashboard UI (edit for deeper
customisation)
├── wallpaper.jpg     ← background image
└── manual.pdf        ← this document
```

2 Setup

2.1 Step 1 — Install Plash

1. Open the **Mac App Store** and search for *Plash*, or visit sindresorhus.com/plash.
2. Click **Get** and install. Plash is free.
3. Launch Plash. A small icon appears in the menu bar.

2.2 Step 2 — Point Plash at the Dashboard

1. Click the Plash menu bar icon.
2. Choose **Open URL…**
3. Paste this path (adjust if you moved the folder):

```
file:///Users/YOUR_USERNAME/temp/planning-wallpaper/wallpaper.html
```

Replace `YOUR_USERNAME` with your macOS username.

4. Press **Enter**. The planning dashboard appears as your wallpaper immediately.

2.3 Step 3 — Set Plash to Launch at Login *(optional)*

In the Plash menu: **Settings** → **Launch at Login**. The dashboard will be ready every time you start your Mac.

3 Daily Workflow

The typical daily routine takes **under two minutes**:

1. Open `tasks.js` in any text editor (TextEdit, VS Code, Cursor, etc.)
2. Update `done:` flags for completed tasks
3. Add or remove tasks for the day
4. Adjust Gantt bar dates if project timelines shifted
5. Save the file
6. Click the Plash menu bar icon → **Reload**

The dashboard updates instantly.

3.1 Morning Routine

At the start of each day:

1. Reset all task `done` values to `false`
2. Set `sprintName` to describe today's focus (e.g. `"Design Sprint Day 3"`)
3. Update `mustWinsRange` if your target count changed
4. Slide Gantt bars forward by one day (increment all `start` / `end` values by -1, or shift relative to today)

3.2 Evening Shutdown Ritual

The yellow **Shutdown Ritual** note at the bottom of the Command Center panel reminds you what to do before closing up:

1. Mark completed tasks as `done: true`
2. Review Gantt bars and push any slipped deadlines
3. Prepare tomorrow's task list
4. Reload Plash to confirm the dashboard looks correct for tomorrow

4 Editing `tasks.js`

Open `tasks.js` in any text editor. The structure is:

```
window.tasksData = {
  appearance: { ... },   // visual settings
  sprintName: "...",
  mustWinsRange: "...",
  shutdownRitual: "...",
  dailyTasks: [ ... ],
  weekProjects: [ ... ],
  twoWeekProjects: [ ... ]
};
```

4.1 Command Center (Left Panel)

4.1.1 Sprint Name

```
sprintName: "Design Sprint Day 3",
```

Displayed under the **Command Center** heading as "TODAY: Design Sprint Day 3".

4.1.2 Must-Wins Badge

```
mustWinsRange: "3-5",
```

Shown in the red badge at the bottom of the left panel. Use it to set your minimum/maximum non-negotiable completions for the day.

4.1.3 Shutdown Ritual Note

```
shutdownRitual: "Check Deadlines, Set 3-5",
```

Displayed in the yellow note at the very bottom. Write whatever end-of-day reminder works for you.

4.1.4 Daily Task Checklist

```
dailyTasks: [
  { text: "Review and prioritize inbox",   done: true  },
  { text: "Complete top 3 priority tasks", done: false },
  { text: "Team standup meeting",          done: false },
],
```

Each entry has:

- `text` — the label shown on screen

- `done` — `true` shows a filled ✓ circle with strikethrough; `false` shows an empty circle

You can have any number of tasks. Five to seven items is recommended for readability.

4.2 Gantt Charts

Both Gantt panels use the same format. Days are **relative to today**:

Value	Meaning
`start: 0`	Starts today
`start: 2`	Starts in 2 days
`end: 5`	Ends in 5 days
`end: 7`	Ends at the 7-day boundary (last column)

4.2.1 1-Week Gantt (`weekProjects`)

Shows days 0 through 7. Use for tasks and deliverables due this week.

```
weekProjects: [
  { name: "Website Redesign",  start: 0, end: 3, color: "#4a90d9" },
  { name: "Q1 Report Draft",   start: 1, end: 5, color: "#5ba85b" },
  { name: "Client Deadline",   start: 4, end: 7, color: "#e84a5f" },
],
```

4.2.2 2-Week Gantt (`twoWeekProjects`)

Shows days 0 through 14. Use for longer-running milestones and upcoming deadlines.

```
twoWeekProjects: [
  { name: "Prep Milestone",  start: 0,  end: 5,  color: "#4a90d9" },
  { name: "Launch Prep",     start: 6,  end: 12, color: "#e8734a" },
  { name: "Review & Ship",   start: 10, end: 14, color: "#e84a5f" },
],
```

4.2.3 Color Reference

Hex	Swatch	Suggested Use
`#4a90d9`		Blue — normal / in-progress
`#5ba85b`		Green — on track / nearly done
`#e8734a`		Orange — at risk
`#e84a5f`		Red — critical / overdue

`#9b6dff`		Purple — blocked / waiting
`#f0c040`		Yellow — on hold

5 Appearance Settings

All visual controls live in the `appearance` block at the top of `tasks.js`. Save the file and reload Plash to see changes.

```
appearance: {
  wallpaper:    "wallpaper.jpg",
  scrimOpacity: 0.38,
  panelOpacity: 0.62,
  panelBlur:    22,
},
```

5.1 `wallpaper` — Background Image

The filename of the image to use as the background. The file must be in the same folder as `wallpaper.html`.

```
wallpaper: "wallpaper.jpg"    // use this image
wallpaper: ""                 // transparent (shows macOS wallpaper
behind Plash)
```

To use a different image, place it in the `planning-wallpaper/` folder and update the filename. Supported formats: JPG, PNG, WebP.

Tip: To convert a macOS `.heic` wallpaper to JPG, run in Terminal:

```
sips -s format jpeg /path/to/source.heic \
  --out ~/temp/planning-wallpaper/wallpaper.jpg
```

5.2 `scrimOpacity` — Darkness Overlay

A semi-transparent black layer sits between the wallpaper and the panels. Increasing it darkens the wallpaper and improves text contrast.

Value	Effect
`0.0`	No overlay — raw wallpaper
`0.20`	Light tint — wallpaper dominates
`0.38`	**Default** — balanced contrast
`0.55`	Heavy tint — strong readability
`1.0`	Solid black — wallpaper invisible

5.3 `panelOpacity` — Glass Panel Fill

Controls how opaque the frosted-glass panels are.

Value	Effect
`0.20`	Nearly transparent — maximum wallpaper bleed-through
`0.40`	Light glass
`0.62`	**Default** — balanced glass
`0.80`	Solid-looking panels
`1.0`	Fully opaque (no glass effect)

5.4 `panelBlur` — Backdrop Blur

Controls the frosted-glass blur strength in pixels.

Value	Effect
`0`	No blur — sharp background visible through panels
`10`	Light frost
`22`	**Default** — standard frosted glass
`40`	Heavy frost — background almost unrecognisable

5.5 Showing the Live Aerial Wallpaper Behind Plash

To let macOS's live Aerial video show through the dashboard instead of a static image:

1. Set `wallpaper: ""` in `tasks.js`
2. In Plash: right-click the menu bar icon → **Settings** → enable **Transparent Background**
3. Set `scrimOpacity: 0.0` (or a small value like `0.2`) since the scrim won't have a static image to darken
4. Reload Plash

6 Reloading After Changes

Every time you save `tasks.js`, reload Plash to apply the changes:

Method	How
Menu bar	Click Plash icon → **Reload**
Keyboard shortcut	Assign one in Plash → Settings → Keyboard Shortcut

7 Troubleshooting

7.1 Dashboard is blank or shows an error

- Make sure the path in Plash starts with `file:///` (three slashes)
- Confirm `tasks.js` is in the same folder as `wallpaper.html`
- Open `wallpaper.html` in Safari or Chrome directly — any JavaScript errors will appear in Developer Tools (`Cmd+Option+I`)

7.2 Wallpaper image not showing

- Confirm `wallpaper.jpg` (or your custom filename) exists in the `planning-wallpaper/` folder
- Check the `wallpaper:` value in `tasks.js` matches the exact filename including extension

7.3 Panels are unreadable (too transparent or dark)

Adjust `scrimOpacity` and `panelOpacity` in `tasks.js` :

- If text is hard to read → increase `scrimOpacity` toward `0.55`
- If panels look too solid → decrease `panelOpacity` toward `0.40`

7.4 Gantt bars are missing or wrong

- All `start` and `end` values must be within range: 0–7 for `weekProjects` , 0–14 for `twoWeekProjects`
- `start` must be less than `end`
- Check for missing commas or unclosed brackets in `tasks.js` — open the file in a code editor with syntax highlighting to spot errors quickly

7.5 Dashboard does not update after saving `tasks.js`

Click the Plash icon → **Reload**. Plash does not watch for file changes automatically.

8 Quick Reference

Task	What to change
Update today's tasks	`dailyTasks` in `tasks.js`
Mark a task done	`done: true` on that task entry
Change sprint name	`sprintName` in `tasks.js`
Change must-wins count	`mustWinsRange` in `tasks.js`
Adjust project timelines	`start` / `end` in `weekProjects` or `twoWeekProjects`
Change a project colour	`color` on that project entry
Darken/lighten background	`scrimOpacity` in `appearance`
Make panels more/less opaque	`panelOpacity` in `appearance`
Change blur strength	`panelBlur` in `appearance`
Swap background image	`wallpaper` filename in `appearance`
Reload the dashboard	Plash menu bar icon → **Reload**